

The 6:15

THURSDAY · AUGUST 27, 2026

NO. 7

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS)

Thu 8/27	Marvell (MRVL) aft. close — cons. rev. \$2.71-2.72B (+35% Y/Y), EPS \$0.93; jobless claims 8:30a (not yet out at press time); 4-week bill auction settling 9/1; Jackson Hole opens (thru 8/29) — registration, academic sessions today.
Fri 8/28	Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, ~10:00a ET (exact time pending Wed-evening agenda).
Tue 9/8	Canada's retaliatory "dollar-for-dollar" tariffs on U.S. steel, dairy, appliances, ag equipment, pulp/paper, electronics take effect. [NEW]
Fri 9/4	August jobs report (nonfarm payrolls), 8:30a (BLS).
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision.

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic's public S-1, reported "as soon as this week" per CNBC's 8/21 story, had not appeared as of press time; still targeting an October Nasdaq listing at a reported ~\$2T valuation vs. its \$965B May Series H. **[flag: not yet filed; valuation reported, not confirmed]** No verified political-primary, rocket-launch, frontier-model or VC-round item fell inside this window this run.

METRICS · TIMES ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	Brent ~\$86.93 indicative (Trading Economics, Thu AM, -1.0%); a separate aggregator shows \$86.77-88.41 overnight, +2.7% — no settle yet, quotes disagree on direction pre-cash-open. WTI last confirmed just under \$83 Wed close (2nd straight down session); no fresher settle located. [flag: no clean settle either grade]
2y/10y/30y	4.19% / 4.66% / 5.18% (Treasury.gov par curve, 8/26 close)
DXY	99.15 (Wed close, +0.24%), still near a 3-month low
S&P / Nasdaq fut.	+0.7% / +0.9% (Thu premarket, on Nvidia); Dow fut. +0.3%
VIX	15.45 (Wed close, -2.5%)

Gold	Eased just below \$4,650/oz Wed, holding near 3-month highs
S&P / Dow / Nasdaq	7,677.24 (+0.3%) / 53,577.40 (+0.3%, 3rd straight gain) / 26,151.30 (+0.7%) — Wed close
Asia / Europe	Nikkei 66,132 (Thu close, -0.2%); Hang Seng 25,566 (Thu close, -0.3% despite the Nvidia beat); STOXX 600 651.90 (Wed close, -0.7%) [DAX not verified this run]
Retail gas	\$4.0997/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/27)

Rates: Treasury.gov daily par yield curve. Equities/futures: exchange and wire quotes as cited.
Oil: ICE Brent / NYMEX WTI front-month.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 179 (straits.live, as of 8/27 1020Z)
Transits	Kpler: 2 tankers 8/24, lowest since early May, vs. 10-day avg. 14. Lloyd's List and PortWatch: no fresher figures than last issue. [flag: still stale]
Strikes	Metro Venetian (Aframax, Liberian-flag, 8/23-24 off Ash Shishah, Oman) still unattributed — 5th Greek-linked vessel hit in a month, struck during an AIS-dark stretch running since 8/13. [DEVELOPING] Running total: straits.live indexes 55+ crisiswide; Wikipedia's tracker logged 64 thru 8/18 — different inclusion rules, don't net.
War-risk premium	VLCC ~\$10.0M/transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) [underlying quote >1 wk old]
Dark tankers	55 of 156 screened show 3-24h AIS gaps vs. 7-day baseline 60.9 (straits.live) — a floor, not a full estimate

Kpler's near-real-time AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly commercial-transit aggregation, and PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots measure different things over different windows — don't net or average them against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Houston 9-3 Wed 8/26. 74-57, 4 GB Tampa Bay, AL East.
Knicks	Hart extension talks reportedly narrowing to 3-yr/\$60-62M — still unsigned. [DEVELOPING]
Northwestern	Off-season, no new moves.

Nvidia blows past its own guidance again, handing Warsh a stronger tape and a stickier inflation problem on the eve of Jackson Hole

Nvidia reported fiscal second-quarter revenue of \$96.221 billion Wednesday after the close, beating the roughly \$92.1 billion Visible Alpha consensus by about \$4 billion, with Data Center revenue of \$89.0 billion — up 117% year-over-year and now 92% of total sales. Non-GAAP EPS of \$2.22 topped the \$2.09 estimate; GAAP EPS came in at \$2.46. Gross margin held at 75.0% on both a GAAP and non-GAAP basis, matching guidance despite what the company has flagged as rising memory and wafer costs. The mechanism that actually moved markets: Q3 revenue guidance of \$108.0 billion, plus or minus 2%, cleared Wall Street's roughly \$104.2 billion consensus by nearly \$4 billion — a bigger beat-and-raise than the deceleration narrative around Nvidia's cooling year-over-year growth rate (106% this quarter, down from triple digits a year ago) had priced in. CFO Colette Kress told analysts she expects roughly 70% revenue growth in fiscal 2028, an unusually explicit multi-year figure for a company that has mostly declined to guide beyond a single quarter. [NEW]

The market's reaction confirms the scale of the beat. NVDA rose as much as 6% in Wednesday's after-hours session and was still up roughly 6% in Thursday's premarket, dragging S&P 500 futures up 0.7% and Nasdaq 100 futures up 0.9% ahead of the bell — a sharper premarket move than Monday's Iran-sanctions announcement produced in either direction. Salesforce and CrowdStrike, which also reported Wednesday, reinforced the tape: Salesforce posted \$11.3 billion in revenue (+11% Y/Y) and raised FY27 guidance by \$200-

300 million; CrowdStrike beat on both lines (\$1.47B revenue vs. \$1.44B expected, EPS \$0.31 vs. \$0.29) and lifted its full-year outlook. [read: three consecutive AI-adjacent beats in one evening is the clearest signal yet that this week's "high-beta earnings risk" framing had it backwards — Monday's pre-print chip selloff was defensive positioning, not a read on the fundamentals.]

The second-order consequence lands at the same moment. Wednesday's other release was the Q2 GDP second estimate: unrevised at 1.5% annualized growth, but with the report's embedded PCE price index revised up two-tenths to 5.3% headline and 3.6% core — both hotter than the advance reading. [fact] That is a different series from the Fed's preferred July PCE index, also out Wednesday, which showed core PCE up 0.2% month-on-month and 3.3% year-on-year — but both move the same direction: inflation readings ticking up, not down, the day before Jackson Hole opens and two days before Warsh's first keynote as chair. [read: a resilient, AI-capex-driven equity tape colliding with stickier-than-expected inflation data is close to the worst setup for a new Fed chair trying to use Friday's speech to signal a data-dependent, market-anchored policy path — strong growth and firm inflation together argue against the rate cuts markets have been pricing, right as his own credibility is freshly contested.]

That contest is explicit. Treasury Secretary Bessent raised the ceiling on the department's long-bond buybacks from \$2 billion to at least \$4 billion this month, an intervention that has helped pull the 10-year to 4.66% and the 30-year to 5.18% (Treasury.gov, 8/26) — a genuine yield decline, but one FX desks including Bank of America say is muddying the market-rate signal Warsh needs to calibrate Friday's message, with the dollar (DXY 99.15) still pinned near a

three-month low on fiscal-risk concerns. [read: Nvidia's beat buys Warsh nothing on the inflation side of his mandate and complicates the growth side too — a Fed chair who wants an unfiltered bond market is instead getting artificially suppressed yields from his own Treasury Secretary at the exact moment equities are telling him the economy doesn't need rescuing.] Marvell reports after Thursday's close as the week's last major AI-capex data point before Warsh speaks Friday morning — and after Wednesday's Dick's Sporting Goods collapse (see Business), a reminder that not every earnings print this week is landing on the same side of the beat-and-raise story.

POLITICS

Lisa Cook's attorney Abbe Lowell submitted a five-page letter to the White House Wednesday, meeting the deadline Deputy Chief of Staff Dan Scavino set three weeks earlier, arguing the mortgage-fraud allegations underlying Trump's renewed removal effort "remain unfounded and untrue" and that any application errors were inadvertent, partly attributable to lender paperwork, and don't rise to "cause" under the Federal Reserve Act. [NEW: formal response filed] The dispute runs on a track separate from the Supreme Court's own scheduled January review of Trump's removal authority generally. No White House response to Lowell's letter had surfaced as of press time — the next move is Trump's, and a second removal attempt without new cause would likely restart the emergency-litigation cycle that already reached the Supreme Court once this year, on a docket the Court has already agreed to hear on the merits with argument set for January. [read: the timing crowds a Fed-independence story into the same week as the GDP/PCE data cluster and Jackson Hole, even though markets are watching Warsh's Friday

speech for entirely separate reasons.] Scavino's original letter had argued there is "sufficient reason to believe" Cook made false statements on mortgage agreements; Lowell's response frames every disputed entry as either a lender-side error or immaterial to loan terms, the same defense his client has maintained publicly since the removal fight began roughly a year ago. The House-Senate government-funding gap (Senate CR to Dec. 11, House's own version only to Dec. 4) remains unresolved, with the House still in recess and no new movement logged.

ECONOMICS

Wednesday's GDP release also showed real gross domestic income up 2.2% (vs. 1.2% in Q1) and corporate profits up \$400.9 billion in the quarter — more than five times Q1's \$74.4 billion gain — a detail the lead didn't cover and one that argues the underlying economy strengthened in Q2 beyond the headline growth number. [NEW] Thursday's weekly jobless claims (8:30a) had not been released as of press time; the last confirmed reading was 206,000 for the week ended Aug. 15, below the 210,000 consensus and down from a revised 212,000 the week prior, with the four-week moving average at 204,000 — a labor market still showing no cracks. Jackson Hole's Thursday agenda is limited to registration and academic paper sessions ahead of Friday's keynotes; roughly 120 attendees from more than 70 countries convene under the theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy." Warsh has called his own speech "a blank piece of paper," declining to preview its framing. The July PCE report released Wednesday also showed real (inflation-adjusted) consumer spending unchanged on the month, a soft read on the underlying demand pulse embedded inside the same release the market otherwise treated as a hot-

inflation print — a distinction likely to matter more to the Fed's internal debate than to Thursday's headlines. The Treasury's own 4-week bill auction settles Monday, a routine event on its own, but one worth watching given Bessent's buyback expansion (see Lead) — any tail or bid-to-cover softness at the short end this month would be read as the first market pushback on the intervention rather than as noise.

BUSINESS

Dick's Sporting Goods collapsed 30% Tuesday — its worst single session since 2023 — after adjusted EPS of \$3.53 and revenue of \$5.59 billion both missed the Street's \$3.76 and \$5.65 billion, and management cut its full-year sales and operating-profit outlook, citing heavier promotional activity and a thinner new-product pipeline in athletic footwear. [NEW] The headline comp of +4.9% (World Cup-driven, broad-based) masked the actual problem: the Foot Locker business Dick's acquired this year ran a -3.6% proforma comp, meaning the miss and the guidance cut trace specifically to the roughly \$2.4 billion of ex-Dick's revenue layered into the base by that deal, not to the core banner. [read: a 30% drawdown on a guidance cut this size, on an acquisition-driven revenue base, says the market had been pricing Foot Locker's integration as accretive rather than dilutive — Tuesday reprices that assumption in one session rather than gradually.] Intuit was the opposite story: fiscal Q4 adjusted EPS of \$4.03 beat the \$3.58 estimate by double digits, revenue rose 13.65% Y/Y to \$4.354 billion against a \$4.268 billion consensus, and full-year EPS growth came in at 20% on both a GAAP and non-GAAP basis. Intuit's "Big Bets" segments (assisted tax, money, mid-market) grew a combined 34% and now make up 30% of revenue; FY27 guidance of \$23.28-23.51 billion in revenue

(+9-10%) and \$22.88-23.12 non-GAAP EPS (+23-24%) came in ahead of where the buy side had modeled. [NEW]

Marvell reports after Thursday's close, guided to \$2.70 billion in revenue ($\pm 5\%$) and \$0.93 non-GAAP EPS ($\pm \0.05), with management already pointing to \$3 billion in Q3 revenue a full quarter ahead of its prior outlook; consensus sits at \$2.71-2.72 billion and \$0.93 — essentially in line with guidance, an unusually tight setup after Nvidia's upside surprise raised the bar for the rest of the AI-chip complex. The U.S.-Canada trade breakdown flagged Monday now has a hard date: Prime Minister Carney says Canada will match the U.S.'s 50% tariffs "dollar for dollar" starting Sept. 8, targeting steel, dairy, appliances, agricultural equipment, pulp and paper, and electronics [NEW: retaliation date set], after the U.S. tariffs (effective Aug. 22, with energy, potash and critical minerals carved out) triggered Carney's suspension of talks last week.

TECHNOLOGY

Beyond the headline numbers in the lead, Nvidia flagged rising memory and wafer costs as the reason its current-quarter gross-margin guidance (74.0% ± 50 bp) sits below the 75.0% just reported — a supply-chain cost pressure now shared across the AI-hardware stack rather than specific to Nvidia. Hyperscaler demand was the other data point buried in Wednesday's print: Nvidia's ACIE (AI clouds, industrial, enterprise) customer segment posted \$40.3 billion in quarterly sales, up 138% year-over-year, while hyperscaler-specific revenue more than doubled to \$48.7 billion — the clearest evidence yet that capacity orders from the largest cloud platforms, not enterprise pilots, are still the dominant swing factor in Nvidia's growth rate. [NEW] No verified frontier-model release or confirmed

major rocket launch surfaced this run beyond items already logged in prior issues; a Chinese lab's model update circulated Wednesday but was single-sourced to an aggregator with no primary confirmation, so it's omitted rather than padded in. Marvell's print (see Business) is the next test of whether the AI-capex trade broadens beyond Nvidia itself.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia and Ukraine continued heavy overnight exchanges into Thursday. Russian forces launched roughly 162 strike drones at Ukrainian regions including Sumy, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, Dnipropetrovsk, Kherson, Kyiv, Odesa, Chernihiv and Poltava; a nighttime strike on Kherson sparked fires at retail outlets and a residential building. [DEVELOPING] Ukraine's own drone campaign hit Russia's Wildberries logistics hub in Tambov Oblast — a fire reportedly spreading over 100,000 square meters — and struck the Lukoil-Nizhegorodnefteorgsintez refinery in Kstovo, Nizhny Novgorod region, continuing the economic-infrastructure targeting Putin called "Pandora's box" Sunday. [continuity: same rhetorical framing, no new Putin statement logged this run] The intensity of Wednesday-into-Thursday's exchange — 162 drones on the Russian side alone, against last issue's 66 Ukrainian-launched count two days earlier — keeps both sides' economic-infrastructure campaigns running well above the pace either had sustained earlier this month, with no diplomatic channel reported active this run. Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with export controls still the open issue; nothing new surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Oman's Foreign Minister Badr al-Busaidi met his Iranian counterpart Araghchi in Tehran Tuesday as planned, with both sides describing talks on the Strait of Hormuz and bilateral ties; Tehran's readout stressed the meeting had "nothing to do" with Washington. [DEVELOPING] No breakthrough, ceasefire framework or reopening timeline was announced by either side as of press time.

The unattributed Metro Venetian strike (see Board) is now feeding a separate political fight: coverage Thursday framed the attack as a test of the Trump administration's public claim that Hormuz remains a "functioning strait," even as U.S. vessels continue escorting tankers along the Omani side of the passage. [NEW: framing fight] No fresher status on the still-detained Amara near Qeshm Island was located this run; its hold status past Aug. 21 remains unconfirmed. The Kpler count of just two tankers transiting Aug. 24 — the lowest single-day tally since early May and well below the vendor's own 10-day average of 14 — is the most concrete evidence this run that flows, not just sentiment, have degraded since the Metro Venetian strike, even accounting for the usual caveat that some vessels transit dark. Iran's Persian Gulf Strait Authority's transit-permit and toll regime, in force since last week with "detention or confiscation" as its stated enforcement threat, remains the likeliest explanation for the collapse in traffic — owners and charterers appear to be routing around the strait entirely rather than testing the new rules, which is a different mechanism than the strike campaign itself deterring transits directly. [read] The threat classification across the strait is unchanged at its tightest reading of the crisis.

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Astros 9-3 Wed 8/26 (Bellinger's go-ahead, bases-loaded double in the 7th). 74-57, 2nd AL East, 4 GB Tampa Bay, holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Off-season, no game. Hart extension talks narrowing toward 3-yr/\$60-62M (see Transactions) — still unsigned.
Northwestern	Off-season, no game. Opens Sat 9/5, 7:00p CT vs. South Dakota State at the temporary Martin Stadium facility — unchanged since 8/25.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 8/25: Khamenei/IRGC command reshuffle, TSMC July revenue, Microsoft's Maia chip orders, Araghchi's standard rhetorical framing, the House-Senate funding gap, Dick's/Intuit earnings recaps. For next issue: report Marvell's actual print and Thursday's actual jobless-claims reading rather than the previews logged here; Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole keynote is the week's single biggest swing factor — report content, not anticipation; watch for Anthropic's S-1 to actually go public; watch Canada's Sept. 8 retaliatory-tariff date approaching; watch for a fresher (sub-week) Hormuz transit count from Lloyd's List or PortWatch, both still stale; watch for attribution on the Metro Venetian strike and any update on Amara past Aug. 21.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.